thamesview

Your magazine from Gallions | gallionsha.co.uk | January 2009



The Gallions Big Tidy Up

Nominate an area for a spring clean

Join our team

Environmental Operative vacancies

Social housing standards

Have your say with the TSA

Volunteer this year

Lots of ways to get involved

Free careers course

Improve your job hunting skills

Thamesview January 2009

kidsview

Gallions Housing Association

Inside: River Keeper Volunteer opportunities, Tavy Bridge update a London's first foodbank.

tw magazine

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Visit our website for even more news!
Bats spotted at Southmere Park, O2 award for local group, Combating condensation, Half tonne clean up at Crossway Lake.
www.gallionsha.co.uk

Gallions wishes you a happy and healthy 2009

This year Gallions will continue to make changes to our service and improve your community. We would like you to work with us so we have included a list of all the Gallions *resident involvement opportunities* in this issue of Thamesview. From taking part in a short survey to joining the Gallions Residents Board there are activities for everyone, whatever your availability and interests.

We are working with Greenwich Community College to offer you a great *free job skills course* in February. You will learn how to write a better CV and get tips on searching for the right job – contact us if you would like to book a place. We also have *Environmental Operative vacancies* at Gallions so send us a CV if you would like to join our team.

If you want to get active in the New Year *become a Thamesmead River Keeper Volunteer*. You will meet new people, protect the local environment and make our waterways better places to visit.

There are some great tips for *managing the credit crunch* in the leaseholders section of this magazine - make sure you take a look.

Don't forget to *get in touch* with us if you want to get involved with anything we do or have questions and comments. Email us at thamesview@gallionsha.co.uk or call the Thamesview team on 0800 83 84 81.

Gallions Housing Association

FSC Mixed Sources

GRB GALLIONS RESIDENTS' BOARD APPROVED

Demolition
to begin at Tavy Bridge

This month demolition works will start at Tavy Bridge, with phase two of the regeneration project due to start later in the year. The following areas will be demolished:

- **Pyramid Club**
- **Old health centre**
- **Steps between the Pyramid Club and Tilehurst Point**
- **Some raised walkways**
- **Play area and equipment**



You will still be able to access the shops throughout the process and these will be open as usual. Parking will not be available underneath the old health centre from early January until the demolition has finished.

Please contact Linda Harris on 0208 320 3557 or visit the Tavy Bridge Project Office Tuesday to Thursday if you have any queries about the demolition or would like a map showing the demolition areas.

Inspectors get started

In December, more than twenty Gallions residents attended a Resident Inspectors Introduction Day to meet some of our staff, learn about how Gallions operates and find out what being a Resident Inspector involves.

Gallions Resident Inspectors are volunteers who will help us monitor the quality of our services. Training will start next month, with the first round of inspections due to take place in April.

Resident Inspectors will begin by carrying out inspections of empty properties, helping to improve the standards when new residents move in.

Find out more about the Resident Inspector scheme and how you can get involved by contacting Marie Dunster on 0800 83 84 81 or email mdunster@gallionsha.co.uk.

The Big Tidy Up comes to you

The organisation responsible for the Keep Britain Tidy campaign has launched the Big Tidy Up – the country's biggest ever litter tidy up! This year Gallions will be running a series of Big Tidy Up events across our neighbourhoods to help improve the area where you live.

We want you to nominate a street or place near you that would benefit from a Big Tidy Up later in the year. It can be an area that has attracted a lot of litter or graffiti and it can be a large or small space. We also need volunteers to take part in the Big Tidy Up activities to make the project a BIG success!

If you, your neighbours, school or business would like to get involved please contact Sue Asquith on 0208 320 3471 or email sasquith@gallionsha.co.uk. Visit our website www.gallionsha.co.uk or call 0800 83 84 81 for more details and a nomination form.



London's first foodbank

The Trussel Trust is a charity that runs a foodbank scheme to help people in times of crisis. The Trust has helped to set up more than thirty foodbanks across the UK which provide food boxes to support a family in need for three days.

The Thamesmead foodbank is due to open next month and it will be the first one in London. A number of local churches, including Emmanuel Baptist Church, Yarnton Way have worked together to offer this service especially for Thamesmead and Abbey Wood residents.

Foodbanks are exclusively for those experiencing serious financial or emotional difficulties and users must have a food voucher to collect a food box.

Food vouchers are only available via registered care professionals, including health visitors and church pastoral workers.

You can help this worthy cause by donating tinned or packet food. Drop off your donations in our reception at Harrow Manor Way in January. Find out more by contacting Marie Dunster on 0800 83 84 81 or emailing mdunster@gallionsha.co.uk.

Lots of ways to get involved

There are thirteen great ways you can get involved with Gallions and help us to improve your neighbourhood, enhance our service and protect the environment. You don't have to be able to volunteer lots of your time and you can choose an activity that interests you.

If you don't have much time you could try these opportunities:

1. **Estate walkabouts**
2. **Walking forums**
3. **Resident surveys**

If you have some spare time join in with these activities:

4. **Focus groups**
5. **Thamesview Editorial Panel**
6. **Friends of Thamesmead Parks**
7. **Team Gallions Interest Group**
8. **Block representative**
9. **Resident Inspector**
10. **Resident Association**
11. **Tenant Disability Action Group**

If you have lots of time you could make a big difference:

12. **Gallions Residents Board**
13. **Gallions Housing Association Board Member**

Contact Helen Chambers on 0800 83 84 81, visit our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk or pop into our reception if you would like to find out more and get involved. We can pay expenses and offer training and support.

The Moorings in 2009

Last year Gallions selected the Moorings area in central Thamesmead as the next possible neighbourhood to be regenerated.

Gallions asked the Housing Corporation (now closed and replaced by the Tenant Services Authority and the Homes and Communities Agency - more about this change on page 12) to extend the deadline for completing the Decent Homes Works and we have applied to the Mayor of London's Regional Housing Office for additional funding for the project.

We will soon find out if our applications have been successful. Once we have decisions from these organisations we will be able to create more detailed plans for the area and begin working on the project.

We will write to all Moorings residents as soon as we have more information and will provide updates on our website and in forthcoming issues of Thamesview. If you would like to find out more about the Moorings contact the Neighbourhood Projects team on 0800 83 84 81.

Make a splash as a River Keeper Volunteer



Thames21, an environmental charity based in London, is looking for volunteers to join the River Keeper Volunteer team in Thamesmead.

The volunteers will work with an experienced Thames21 River Keeper Co-ordinator clearing litter in and around the river, lakes, and canals, protecting wildlife habitats and improving the waterside landscape. The volunteer team is made up of people who are passionate about protecting the local environment and want to encourage others that live or work in the area to enjoy our waterways.

You can join the team at any time. Volunteers must be at least sixteen years old, physically fit and able to commit four hours per week, including occasional weekends. Thames21 provide all equipment and training for volunteers.

Gallions works in partnership with Thames21 to look after Thamesmead's waterways and funds a part time Thamesmead River Keeper. Contact Solomon Small on 07826 913261 or email solomon.small@thames21.org.uk to find out more about this scheme.

Free job skills course

Next month Greenwich Community College is offering a free Getting Ready for Work course for local people, aged 19 or over. During the course you will find out how to:

- ★ **Write a great CV**
- ★ **Search for a job successfully**
- ★ **Do well in an interview**
- ★ **Give great presentations**

The course begins on 5th February 2009 and will run for four weeks, with a break for half term on the 19th February. It will take place at Gallions Nature Centre, off Bentham Road every Thursday between 10am and 12pm.

We have eight spaces left so contact Marie Dunster on 0800 83 84 81 or email mdunster@gallionsha.co.uk to book your place and find out more.

Working with the local Police

The Police Safer Neighbourhoods Team is looking for volunteers to work with them to tackle crime and anti-social behaviour in the area. The volunteers will become part of the Thamesmead Moorings Neighbourhood Panel, which is made up of other local people.

The panel works with the Police to identify and prioritise the concerns of the residents in the neighbourhood. The panel meets formally every six weeks, with additional Street Briefings held at different times to interact with other members of the community. Volunteers should be willing to express their concerns and represent the rest of the community. They need to be flexible, open minded and able to feedback and comment upon the results of community safety activity.

If you are interested in joining the panel or would like to find out more contact Sergeant Noel Carmody on 0208 721 2630 or email thamesmeadmoorings.SNT@met.police.uk.



Gallions Housing Association

Environmental Operatives
£14,900 per annum

Thamesmead
Ref: 07/56

At Gallions Housing Association Limited, we want our people to take pride in a job well done. Our Environmental Operatives are a great example of what we mean; they keep our neighbourhoods safe and clean, making life better for literally thousands of our customers.

As a member of a team working in our Thamesmead community, no two days will ever be the same. From dealing with litter and graffiti to cutting grass and maintaining canal banks, you'll be in a position to take on plenty of challenges, for which full training will be provided. You will be required to work 8am to 3.30pm and there are regular opportunities for over-time at weekends and bank holidays

To join us, you'll need experience in a similar role and an understanding of key health and safety issues. A valid driving licence, coupled with demonstrable driving competency will also be essential to this role. In return, for your commitment, we offer competitive salaries, a pension scheme and even an attendance bonus.

To find out more, please visit www.gallionsha.co.uk or email your CV and covering letter to recruitment@gallionsha.co.uk quoting the reference above. Alternatively, if you do not have internet access and would like an information pack, please call 0208 320 3430 and leave your details for a recruitment pack.

SPOTLIGHT ON

Discovery Children's Centre

Discovery Children's Centre is a great new centre especially for families and children. There are all sorts of activities on offer from coffee mornings and baby clinics to interactive story telling and drop-in work and training sessions.

The centre adds new services to its programme regularly so there are always different groups to get involved in. This month they will be introducing skills showcase training to help parents get back to work and in February the bouncing babies group will help you improve your baby's communication skills.

Pop in and meet the team at Discovery Children's Centre, Battery Road, SE28 0JN or call 0208 855 4320.

Local clubs, groups and services for you

Every issue we will be focusing on one group or service in the area. If you'd like us to shine the spotlight on what you do then please get in touch (details on the welcome page). Contact us too if you want to list your group or provide us with updates.

For little ones (under 5)

Goose-e-ganders parent and toddler group, Broadwater Village Hall, telephone 07958 640645.

Toddles, Manor Close Community Hall, Manor Close. Term time, Monday to Friday 9.30am until 11.30am and 12.30pm until 2.30pm.

Toddles with Tavy Bridge Pre-School, Senior Citizens Hall, Tavy Bridge, telephone 07950 853481

Lighthouse Parent and Toddler Group, Emmanuel Church Hall, telephone 0208 312 4700, Wednesdays and Fridays 1.30pm until 3pm.

Young Foundations Pre-School, Emmanuel Church Hall, telephone 0208 312 4700, Monday until Friday 9.30am until 12 noon.

Toy Library, Linton Mead Primary School, Central Way, telephone 0208 310 1902, Friday 9am until 11am, term time only, for under 5s.

Discovery Children's Centre, Battery Road, telephone 0208 855 4320, Monday, Wednesday and Thursday 9am until 4pm and Tuesday and Friday 9am until 1.30pm.

Editor's note: Thamesview does not endorse or recommend any clubs or groups listed. We aim to provide accurate and up to date information but cannot be held responsible for any misleading or inaccurate information supplied to us.

For bigger ones

The cAve climbing wall, Arch 3, Harrow Manor Way, telephone 0208 320 4494, www.trust-thamesmeadcave.co.uk, Monday to Friday 4pm until 7pm and weekends 1.30pm until 5.30pm, for under 18s.

Fun Club, Glimpsing Green, telephone 0208 311 6777, Saturday mornings, for under 11s with a disability.

JMF Support Group, Jubilee Hall, Lytton Strachey Path, telephone 0208 310 5885, Saturday 1pm until 3pm.

Rainbows, Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 0208 310 2419, for 5 to 7 year olds.

Rainbows, Abbey Wood Community Centre, 4 Knee Hill, telephone 0208 311 2239, Wednesday 4.45pm until 6pm, for 5 to 7 year olds.

Brownies and Guides, Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 0208 310 2419, for girls aged 7+.

Brownies, Greenmead Community Centre, telephone 07960 815229, Every Tuesday from 6pm, Girls age 7 to 10.

New Acres Library, Tavy Bridge, telephone 0208 311 5291, for all young people, from babies to teenagers.

Hawksmoor Youth Club, Bentham Road, telephone 0208 312 4022.

Heronsgate Youth Club, Whinchat Road, 07950 612826

Performing Arts

Dynamix, Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 07796 450093, for ages 8 to 19.

Theatre Street, Broadwater Village Hall, Gooseander Way, telephone 01322 441977, www.theatrestreet.com, tots to adults.

Youth Advisory Project, 12 Tavy Bridge, telephone 0208 311 5111, for 16 to 24 year olds.

Threshold Dance and Drama, Jubilee Community Centre, Lytton Strachey Path off Titmuss Avenue, telephone 07949 601935, www.thresholddanceanddrama.co.uk, different times for ages 5 to16.

Young at Heart

Monday Club Bingo, Jubilee Community Centre, Lytton Strachey Path off Titmuss Avenue, telephone 0208 311 5707, Monday 2pm until 4pm.

Over 50s Bingo Club, Greenmead Community Hall, Lime Row, telephone 0208 311 0366, Monday and Thursday 7pm until 9pm.

Rendezvous Club, Evenlode House, Coralline Walk, telephone 0208 310 7437, Wednesday, for the over 55s.

The Atrium Community Centre, Teeswater Court, telephone 0800 83 84 81, 7 days a week. Fun and free over 50s keep fit classes run Wednesday 4.30pm until 5.30pm.

Events Calendar

There are exciting things happening in your area!

January 09

Chinese New Year 26 January

Celebrate the Year of the Ox and find out about the traditions and culture of Chinese New Year at the National Maritime Museum. There will be a range of activities for all the family. **Need more details? Call 020 8858 4422 or email bookings@nmm.ac.uk.**

National Holocaust Memorial Day 27 January

Walk London Winter Wanders Weekend 31 January – 1 February

Join the Walk London team for a free led walk in your local area. There are walks for different abilities and ages and you can come on your own or bring your family and friends. Try the Erith to Old Bexley London Loop or the Charlton station to Plumstead Green Chain Walk. **Need more details? Visit www.walklondon.org.uk or call 0870 240 6094.**

February 09

Valentines Day 14 February

Half term for Bexley and Greenwich schools 16 – 20 February

Shrove Tuesday 24 February

Shrove Tuesday is the day before Lent starts: the Tuesday before Ash Wednesday. Shrove Tuesday is sometimes called Pancake Day after the food we eat on this day. **Need more details? Visit www.pancakerecipes.net for recipe ideas.**

Events Calendar



March 09

No Smoking Day 11 March

Every year more than a million people quit smoking on No Smoking Day. If you'd like to try giving up this could be a great day to start. **Need more details? Visit www.nosmokingday.org.uk or call the free NHS Smoking Helpline on 0800 022 4 332.**

St Patricks Day 17 March

Mothers Day 22 March

British Summer Time begins 29 March

Don't forget to put your clocks forward by 1 hour.

April 09

Passover (Jewish) 9 April

Easter weekend 10 - 12 April

Easter holidays for Bexley and Greenwich schools 6 - 17 April

Vaisakhi (Sikh) 14 April

Grand Spring Fair 18 April

Pop along to Belvedere Baptist Church in Nuxley Road between 10am until 12.30pm and enjoy a great free Spring Fair. There will be lots of goodies for everyone including collectables and toys. **Need more details? Call 0208 310 5018.**

London Marathon 26 April

There will be road closures in the Greenwich and Woolwich areas when the marathon takes place. **Need more details? Visit www.london-marathon.co.uk or call 020 7902 0200 to find out more.**

Just for Fun!



Take some time out to enjoy our brainteasers. You only have to complete our wordsearch for the chance to win a fabulous prize!

1 The best of 2008

How well do you remember the events of last year? This quiz will test your 2008 knowledge.

1. *Who was elected as the 44th president of America?*

2. *Which intrepid explorer returned to the big screen last year, after a 19 year break?*

3. *Where were the 2008 Olympics held?*

4. *What are the names of the twins of Brad Pitt and Angelina Jolie born in 2008?*

5. *Which bubbly 1980s chocolate made a big comeback last year?*

2 Linking up

Use the clues and change one letter each time to turn the word bend into gong. We have done the first one to help you.

Bend - *to curve or twist*

_____ - *a musical group*

_____ - *the earth's surface*

_____ - *small country road*

_____ - *by yourself*

_____ - *departed or used up*

Gong

Answers:
1. Barack Obama, Indiana Jones, Beijing, Knox Leon and Vivienne Marchelline, Wigan.
2. Band, land, lane, lone, gone

3 Wordsearch

The Thamesview Team will be celebrating St Patrick's Day in March. Discover all the words relating to Ireland and it's patron saint and you could win a £30 Morrisons voucher.

Shamrock **Guinness** **Harp** **Leprechaun**
Dancing **Luck** **Euro** **Gaelic**

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Please return

Please return the completed wordsearch with your details to: Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH or drop it into our reception by 27th February 2009. The winner will be selected at random.

Name: .....

Address: .....

Telephone: .....

Email: .....

Congratulations to Lindsey Woods of Cole Close who was selected as the winner of our last wordsearch competition.

Introducing the new housing regulators

On 30th November 2008 the Housing Corporation, the government agency that regulated housing associations and funded new affordable housing in England, closed. Two new agencies were created instead; the Tenant Services Authority (TSA) and the Homes and Communities Agency. The TSA aims to improve service standards for residents and the Homes and Communities Agency focuses on creating affordable homes and regenerating communities.

The TSA needs to draw up a new set of standards for all social landlords so they have created the National Conversation campaign to find out tenants' views on housing services. The TSA would like as many residents as possible to take part.

There are lots of ways you can get involved with the National Conversation. The TSA will be holding a number of regional events and Gallions will be holding some local events next month. Call the Tenant Services Authority on 0845 230 7000 or visit nationalconversation.co.uk for information about regional events or call our Neighbourhood Projects team on 0800 83 84 81 to find out more.

The changes to how we are regulated will not affect you immediately and you do not need to do anything.

Changes to your payment card

Gallions is now working with Co-op Bank to collect rent and service charge payments, which means that you can no longer make payments via Allpay.

We have sent new payment cards to all of our residents but you don't need to do anything with the card unless you pay online, via the telephone, at the Post Office or in a shop. Just keep your payment card safe in case you need it later.

Online payments

You should now visit our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk to make a payment.

You will need to provide some basic information before you are re-directed to the secure PayPoint page. You can make payments 24 hours a day, 365 days a year with your payment card and a debit or credit card. You cannot pay your rent directly on the PayPoint website.

Telephone payments

At the moment we cannot accept telephone payments. This service should be available in February - then you should call 0800 83 84 81 with your payment card and a debit or credit card. You will be able make payments 24 hours a day, 365 days a year.

Post Office or local shop payments

You can make a payment at any post office or shop displaying the PayPoint sign.

You need your new payment card as well as cash, debit card, credit card or cheque depending on what payment method the shop accepts.

Other ways to pay

If you normally pay your rent by direct debit, standing order, post or receive Housing Benefit you do not need to do anything with your new payment card.

Please keep your card safe in case your circumstances change or you need to make ad hoc payments.

Call us on 0800 83 84 81, visit our reception or log on at www.gallionsha.co.uk to find out more.

At Gallions we celebrate the diversity of our neighbourhoods. We offer a comprehensive translation service to make communicating with us easy. If you would like this issue of Thamesview magazine translated into your own language please contact us. You can call 0800 83 84 81, email translations@gallionsha.co.uk or visit our office at Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH. We can translate documents into any language and have audio, large print and Braille options available.

ਗੈਲੀਅਨਜ਼ ਵਿਚ ਅਸੀਂ ਆਪਣੇ ਇਲਾਕਿਆਂ ਵਿਚਲੇ ਵਖਰੇਵਿਆਂ ਦੀ ਕਦਰ ਕਰਦੇ ਹਾਂ। ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਗੱਲ ਬਾਤ ਕਰਨ ਲਈ ਸੌਖਾ ਬਣਾਉਣ ਲਈ ਅਸੀਂ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਕਰਨ ਦੀ ਮੁਕੰਮਲ ਸਹੂਲਤ ਦਿੰਦੇ ਹਾਂ। ਜੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਆਪਣੇ ਘਰ ਦੀ ਸਾਡੀ ਮਜ਼ਮੀਆਜ਼ ਨੂੰ ਵੇਚਣ ਬਾਰੇ ਇਸ ਪਰਚੇ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਆਪਣੀ ਬੋਲੀ ਵਿਚ ਕਰਵਾਉਣਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਸੰਪਰਕ ਕਰੋ। ਤੁਸੀਂ ਸਾਨੂੰ ਨੰਬਰ 0800 83 84 81 'ਤੇ ਫੋਨ ਕਰ ਸਕਦੇ ਹੋ, ਜਾਂ ਇਸ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਈਮੇਲ ਭੇਜ ਸਕਦੇ ਹੋ translations@gallionsha.co.uk ਜਾਂ ਅੱਗੇ ਦੀ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਸਾਡੇ ਦਫ਼ਤਰ ਵਿਚ ਮੁਲ ਆ ਸਕਦੇ ਹੋ - Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH. ਅਸੀਂ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ਾ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਕਿਸੇ ਵੀ ਬੋਲੀ ਵਿਚ ਕਰ ਸਕਦੇ ਹਾਂ, ਅਤੇ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਸੁਣਨ ਵਾਲੀ ਟੇਪ 'ਤੇ, ਵੱਡੇ ਅੱਖਰਾਂ ਵਿਚ ਅਤੇ ਬ੍ਰੇਲ ਵਿਚ ਵੀ ਦੇ ਸਕਦੇ ਹਾਂ।

Chúng tôi vui mừng vì sự đa dạng về dân cư ở Gallions. Chúng tôi cung cấp dịch vụ dịch thuật toàn diện để tạo điều kiện dễ dàng cho quí vị liên lạc với chúng tôi. Nếu quí vị muốn dịch số này của cuốn Tạp chí Thamesview sang ngôn ngữ của quí vị, hãy liên hệ với chúng tôi. Quí vị có thể gọi điện thoại theo số 0800 83 84 81, gửi thư điện tử theo địa chỉ translations@gallionsha.co.uk hoặc đến văn phòng của chúng tôi tại Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH. Chúng tôi có thể dịch các tài liệu sang bất kỳ ngôn ngữ nào và luôn sẵn có các lựa chọn khác như ghi âm, in khổ lớn và chữ nổi.

格莱恩斯房屋协會 (Gallions) 頌揚我們鄰舍地區的多元化面貌。我們提供全面的翻譯服務，以便他們與我們進行溝通。如欲要求我們把本期的 Thamesview 雜誌翻譯成繁體中文 (廣東話)，請告訴我們。你可以致電 0800 83 84 81、發送電郵到 translations@gallionsha.co.uk，或親臨我們位於 Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH 的辦事處提出要求。我們可以將文件翻譯成任何語文，也備有語音、特大字體和凸字版本，以供選擇。

Punjabi ◯ **Vietnamese** ◯ **Chinese** ◯
(Please tick one)

Name .....

Address .....

Return to: Anita Dagger, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association Harrow Mannor Way. London SE2 9XH.

New Latest news for leaseholders

This section of Thamesview is especially for our leaseholders and it includes lots of great information about our leasehold service.

Managing the credit crunch

Many people experience financial difficulties at some time in their lives but there are lots of ways you can get help and improve your situation.

1. Get in touch with your creditors (the people you owe money to) straight away and explain your difficulties. Get a contact name of someone you can go and see, phone or write to. If the person you speak to is unhelpful, ask to speak to someone more senior who can help. If you are a Gallions homeowner you should contact Janine Boyle or Ian da Nobrega on 0800 83 84 81.
2. Make sure you tackle your priority debts first as these are the most important. Don't make offers on your other debts until you have negotiated payment of these debts. A list of priority debts and the possible outcomes if an agreement is not met are below:

Debt	Action
Rent or mortgage arrears	Repossession of your home
Council Tax arrears	Bailiffs action or possible imprisonment
Gas, electricity or water	Supply cut off
Magistrates Court Fines	Possible imprisonment
Maintenance	Possible imprisonment

3. Always answer creditor's letters or telephone calls. Don't give up trying to reach an agreement even if they are being difficult and don't ignore the problem.
4. Fill in reply forms to court papers and let the court have all the facts. Attend court hearings, taking a copy of your personal budget with you. Most court hearings take place in private.
5. If you are a leaseholder or homeowner consider taking in a lodger. You will need to inform Gallions, your mortgage lender and your local tax office, as you may have to pay tax on the rent payments you receive. Shared owners are not permitted to sublet their home or provide a tenancy agreement to a lodger.
6. Get advice. Make an appointment with the Gallions Welfare Benefits Adviser or Citizens Advice Bureau Advisor for benefits or financial advice.

Planning for winter

Follow these steps to make sure you stay safe and warm this winter.

1. Gallions homeowners are responsible for maintaining their heating and hot water systems. Make sure your service agreement is up to date and your boiler has had its annual health check.
2. Leaseholders who sublet their properties are legally required to undertake annual gas safety checks and bi-annual electrical checks too.
3. Homeowners and leaseholders are responsible for the pipe work in their property. If you have a leak, you must contact a plumber. Gallions will only investigate a leak if it is a structural or building-wide problem.
4. Check up on your neighbours to make sure they are okay this winter, particularly if they are elderly or have a disability.

Parking problems

Recently there have been problems with residents parking in the wrong bays. Contact us on 0800 83 84 81 to check which bay is yours. Untaxed vehicles parked on Gallions land, including resident parking areas, will be removed by the DVLA or Police.

New look homeowner's handbook

The updated homeowner handbook is now available. If you would like a copy please call the leasehold team on 0800 83 84 81 or pick one up from our reception.

Notice Board



We're here to help

Our reception staff and our customer contact team are fully trained to help you with almost any question or problem. They aim to advise you as quickly as possible and often do not need to transfer you to other members of staff. The team are happy to fill in a form for you, explain a policy and can deal with the most complicated query! You can contact the team 24 hours a day, 365 days a year on 0800 83 84 81.

Surveys show impressive environmental improvements

A year ago Gallions began working with EnCams, to monitor and improve the environment in our neighbourhoods. A number of Gallions staff were trained to carry out local Environmental Quality Surveys and action plans were created to target problem areas. Three times a year we carry out in-depth surveys to look at the amount of litter, graffiti, fly tipping or anti-social behaviour in different parts of our neighbourhoods. Since our first survey in February 2008 half of the environmental elements surveyed have improved in their overall scores, which is a great success. During 2009 our Resident Inspectors will also be trained to carry out the surveys and help us improve the our local environment.





Pie 'n' mash party

The Atrium Community Centre at Teeswater Court has been open for 10 years.

Gallions recently held a pie 'n' mash and sing along celebration to mark the occasion especially for the residents of Teeswater, Shire and Buckwheat Courts who use the facility regularly. Bexley Accessible Transport, Bexley Care Trust and Help the Aged came along to give advice about transport for older people, to check blood pressure and provide tips for keeping warm this winter. Alison Breese, Gallions Director of Operations, made a presentation to local resident Dennis Thompson-Mason, recognising his service to the Atrium and the local community.

Do you need money advice?

Gallions are planning to offer money advice sessions in 2009 to help you understand and manage your finances better. If you are interested in finding out how to open a bank account, manage a budget or deal with debt get in touch with Lesley Edwards on 0800 83 84 81. If there is anything else you want to know about money and finances please let us know.

Thamesmead land owners

We always want you to tell us if there is a problem like flytipping or an abandoned car in your area but sometimes we have to ask you to contact someone else to get the problem resolved. This is because Gallions does not own all the land in Thamesmead and cannot act if the land does not belong to us. Greenwich council, Bexley council, Tilfen Land, Thames Water, The Environment Agency, private developers and other organisations share ownership of the land in Thamesmead. Please be patient with us if we have to ask you to contact another company.

Careers at Gallions

Details of our current employment opportunities are publicised on our website and at our reception desk. Please get in touch on 0800 83 84 81 if you are interested in a career with us.

Complaints and contacts

Gallions aims to provide a first class service to all its residents. However, if you are unhappy with the service you have received there is a policy in place to help you make a complaint. A guide is available on our website.

Complaints@gallionsha.co.uk

www.gallionsha.co.uk

0800 83 84 81

Thamesview publication details

Thamesview is published by Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH and is free to Gallions' residents and anyone else who wishes to obtain a copy.

Community Halls for Hire

Gallions has three great community facilities available to hire in Thamesmead. If you are a leader of a community, fitness or educational group in the area you can book one of our facilities for your meetings or activities.



Atrium Community Hall

Up to 60 seated guests

Kitchen facilities

Communal garden



Gallions Nature Centre

Up to 15 seated guests

Kitchen facilities

Nature trails

Picnic area

Fishing and dipping pond



Tavy Bridge Community Hall

Up to 50 seated guests

Kitchen facilities

Lake view

Outdoor seating and playground

Contact **Lesley Edwards** or **Kelly Sullivan** on **0800 83 84 81** for full information about the rooms available and hire prices.
We cannot accept bookings for private parties.

Gallions Housing Association

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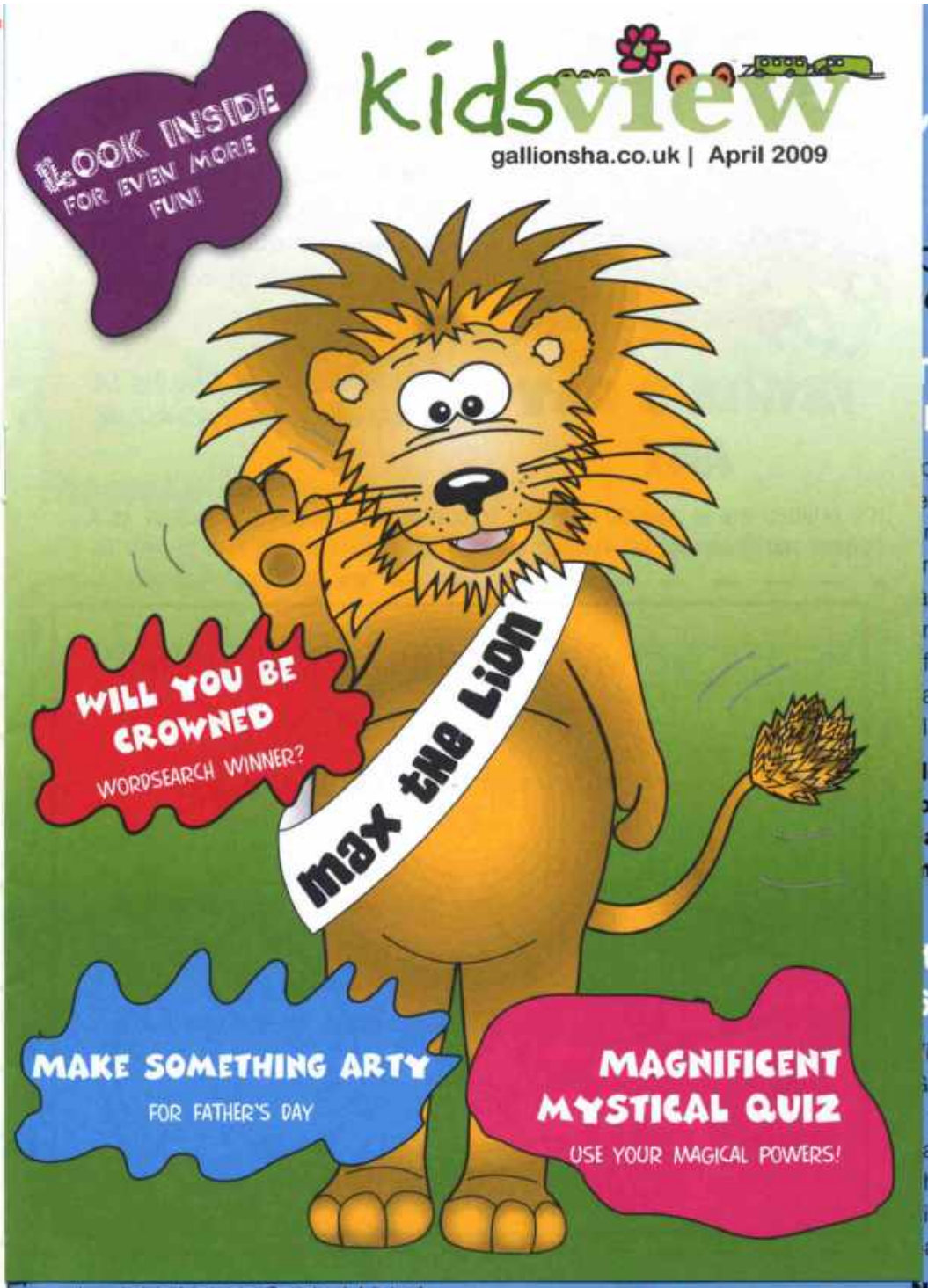
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about this historic Grade 1 Listed industrial building right on our doorstep. This event will focus on the engineering aspects of the giant rotation beam engines that powered the pumps. Admission is £5 with children under 16 free.

Need more details? Call 020 8311 3711 or visit www.crossness.org.uk for further information.

If you would like to register for vacancies with Hays Recruitment you will need to bring a passport or driving licence with you.

June 2

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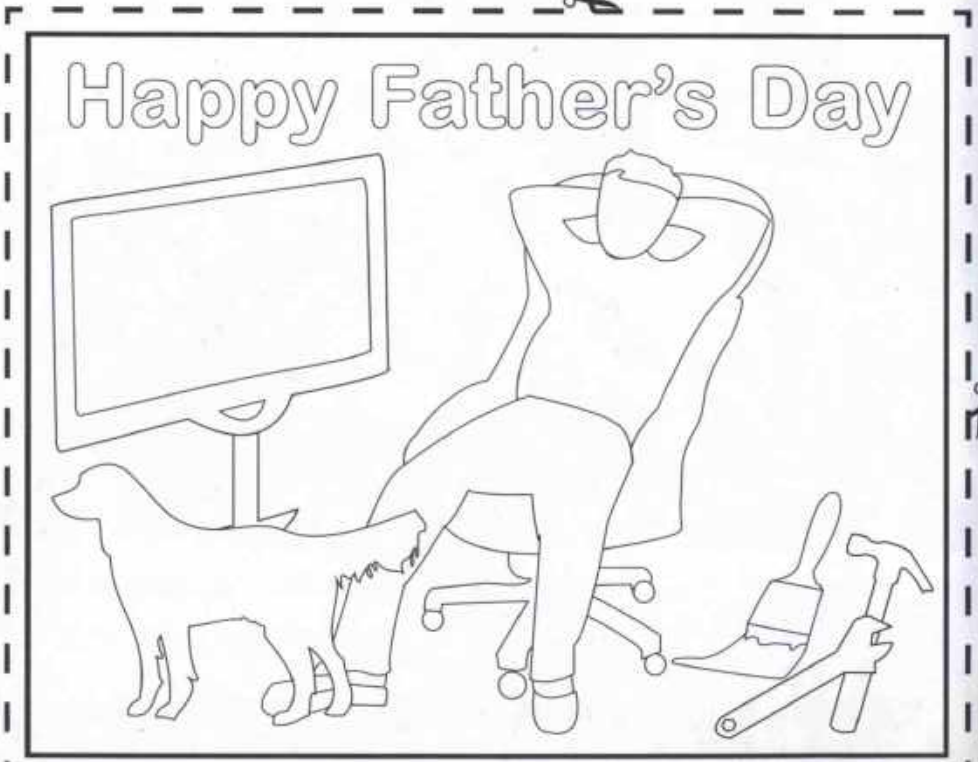
HI!

WELCOME BACK TO KIDSVIEW! I HOPE YOU ENJOY THE COLOURING IN, KINGS AND QUEENS WORDSEARCH AND OTHER GREAT GAMES.

STAY IN CONTACT BY EMAILING ME AT MAXTHELION@GALLIONSHA.CO.UK.

FATHER'S DAY ART

IT'S FATHER'S DAY IN JUNE SO WHY NOT COLOUR IN AND CUT OUT THIS PICTURE AS A PRESENT FOR YOUR DAD, BIG BROTHER OR GRANDDAD?



SPOT THE DIFFERENCE

CAN YOU SPOT THE FOUR DIFFERENCES BETWEEN THESE COLOURFUL EASTER EGGS?





MAGICAL QUIZ

WE'D ALL LOVE TO HAVE SPECIAL MAGICAL POWERS BUT HOW MUCH DO YOU KNOW ABOUT BEING A SORCERER? TAKE OUR QUIZ AND FIND OUT!

1. WHAT IS A WARLOCK?

.....

2. IN WHICH BOOKS BY JK ROWLING ARE THERE WIZARDS?

.....

3. NAME 3 THINGS A MAGICIAN MIGHT HAVE?

.....

4. WHERE DOES DOROTHY GO TO SEE THE WIZARD OF OZ?

.....



ANSWERS
SPOT THE DIFFERENCE - EXTRA GRASS IN PICTURE 1, FLOWER MISSING ON EGG 1, DIFFERENT COLOUR ON EGG 2, EGG 3 IS SMALLER
MAGICAL QUIZ - 1) MALE WITCH 2) HARRY POTTER SERIES 3) MAGIC WAND, HAT, COAK, CRYSTAL BALL, SPELL BOOK, RABBIT 4) EMERALD CITY.

Gallions Housing Association

Strachey Path off Titmuss Avenue, telephone 0208 311 5707, Monday 2pm until 4pm

about this historic Grade 1 Listed industrial building right on our

If you would like to register for vacancies with Hays

COOL COMPETITION!

Max the Lion has been learning all about the history of England and the interesting Kings and Queens. Can you find the names of famous English royalty in this wordsearch?

If you discover all the words send your completed wordsearch and the entry form to us by 8th May 2009 for the chance to win a jam-packed goody bag, including some Horrible Histories books.



Henry 8th
Charles 1st

Elizabeth 2nd
Victoria

James 1st
Richard 3rd

G	Z	Y	H	R	W	R	D	Q	A	T	U
P	U	V	H	I	O	J	X	B	S	M	I
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W	C	R	I	C	H	A	R	D	3	R	D
M	E	B	K	N	X	V	H	G	P	H	T
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Please return your completed form to Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London, SE2 9BR or drop your entry into our reception by 8th May 2009. The winner will be selected at random.

Name: _____

Name of parent or guardian: _____

Address: _____

_____ Telephone: _____

Congratulations to BILLY LAWSON, JORDAN WEBB AND BLESSING OLAPADE who were selected as the winners of our last competition! This competition is open to children under 16 years of age and is free to enter.

Monday Club Bingo, Jubilee Community Centre, Lytton Strachey Path off Titmuss Avenue, telephone 0208 311 5707, Monday 2pm until 4pm

Over 50s Bingo Club, Greenmead Community Hall, Lime Row, telephone 0208 310 0240, Monday and Thursday 7pm until 9pm

Rendezvous Club, Evenlode House, Coralline Walk, telephone 0208 310 7437, Wednesday, for the over 55s

The Atrium Community Centre, Teeswater Court, telephone 0800 83 84 81, 7 days a week. Fun and free over 50s keep fit classes run Wednesday 4.30pm until 5.30pm.

Editor's note: Thamesview does not endorse or recommend any clubs or groups listed. We aim to provide accurate and up to date information but cannot be held responsible for any misleading or inaccurate information supplied to us.

Eve

There are ex

April 20

Easter holid
6 - 17 April

For both Greenwich schools.

Passover (J
9 April

The Jewish festival c commemorates the liberation of the Israe Egyptian slavery.

Vaisakhi (Si
13 April

Vaisakhi is the Sikh festival and it also co 1699, the year Sikhis a collective faith.

Crossness E
Engine Hous
26 April

Take a peak at the C Engine House, Belv Abbey Wood and fin about this historic G industrial building ri doorstep. This event the engineering asp rotation beam engin the pumps. Admissi children under 16 fr

Need more details 020 8311 3711 or crossness.org.uk information.

£25 voucher to be won!

Tell us what you think of Thamesview!

We need your feedback and views to help us make your magazine even better. Whether you have a great idea, suggestion for improvement or just enjoy a particular section we want to hear from you! Complete this questionnaire and return it to us by 30th April 2009 and you could win a £25 voucher.

Contact Anita Dagger on 0800 83 84 81 if you have any problems completing this form or would like to discuss your comments in more detail.

Your details

Name: .....

Address: .....

.....

Contact number: .....

About Thamesview

1. Do you read Thamesview magazine? Yes ☐ No ☐

2. Do you find Thamesview informative? Yes ☐ No ☐

3. Is Thamesview easy to read? Yes ☐ No ☐

4. Do you think Thamesview looks good? Yes ☐ No ☐

Comments and ideas

5. Which stories in Thamesview do you like the **most**? Please tick your 3 favourite types of article.

Updates about your neighbourhood ☐

Work, training or volunteering opportunities ☐

Details of local clubs and groups ☐

Events calendar ☐

Wordsearch and games ☐

Information about Gallions Housing Association ☐

Kidsview magazine ☐

Other (tell us more below) ☐

.....

Gallions Housing Association

6. Which stories in Thamesview do you like the **least**? Please tick your 3 least favourite types of article.

- Updates about your neighbourhood ☐
- Work, training or volunteering opportunities ☐
- Details of local clubs and groups ☐
- Events calendar ☐
- Wordsearch and games ☐
- Information about Gallions Housing Association ☐
- Kidsview magazine ☐
- Other (tell us more below) ☐

7. What, if anything, would you change about Thamesview?

8. Do you have any more comments or ideas to share?

Thank you

We really appreciate the time you have taken to complete this questionnaire. We will use your feedback to improve what we do.

Return this form to Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London SE2 9BR by 30th April 2009 for the chance to win a £25 voucher. The winner will be selected at random.



Gallions Housing Association